

121 GROUP · DESIGN TOKENS

Portal design tokens

Copy these tokens exactly into portal's CSS. Two themes (light + dark), every color value, with verification checklist. One CSS commit cascades through every form field, every card, every hover state across the app — matching our build's design system.

Copy these tokens **exactly** as listed. Don't reinterpret values, don't substitute "close enough" hex codes, don't try to derive them from a generated palette. The design system depends on precise values and the relationships *between* them.

The token names below are CSS custom properties already in our build's stylesheet. Setting them on `:root` (light theme) and `[data-theme="dark"]` (dark theme) cascades the entire visual system — backgrounds, text, borders, status colors, brand accents, shadows, and the depth relationships between them.

Why this matters

A QA item that surfaced during the Add Client modal review: portal's input fields are *lighter* than the surrounding modal background. Our build renders them *darker* (recessed treatment). The inversion came from a single wrong relationship between two tokens (`--bg-soft` and `--bg-elev`) — but it shows up everywhere there's a form field, which is most of the app.

This is the kind of issue that's invisible per-element but loud at the system level. Fix it at the token level, you fix every form field, every hover state, every card surface, in one commit.

The depth metaphor

Dark mode has a narrow contrast band. Hierarchy comes from depth:

```
--bg page background (darkest)
↓
--bg-elev elevated surfaces (cards, modals, panels)
↓
--bg-soft recessed surfaces (input fields, hover backgrounds)
```

The relationship is `--bg-elev > --bg-soft > --bg` on the lightness axis. Inputs sit *inside* cards, both visually and in code. If you invert that relationship (which portal currently does), inputs read as "raised" instead of "recessed" — the affordance is wrong, and the focus ring (blue) loses contrast against the lighter field background.

Apple HIG alignment

Our build's design language is Apple HIG-aligned (per `CLAUDE.md`). The recessed-input pattern is what iOS / macOS Settings, Mail, and every native dark-mode form uses. Copying Apple's depth treatment keeps the app coherent with the platform conventions our users already know.

Light theme tokens

Set these on `:root`:

Backgrounds + surfaces

Token	Value	Use
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--bg	#fbfbfd	Page background
--bg-elev	ffffff	Elevated surfaces (modals, cards, panels)
--bg-soft	#f5f5f7	Recessed surfaces (input fields, hover backgrounds)
--bg-faint	#fafafa	Subtle alternation (zebra rows)
--column-bg	rgba(0,0,0,0.025)	Kanban column wells

Text

Token	Value	Use
--text	#1d1d1f	Primary text (body, headings, input values)
--text-muted	#636366	Secondary text (subtitles, labels)
--text-soft	#86868b	Tertiary text (meta, timestamps)
--text-faint	#aeaeb2	Disabled / placeholder text

Hairlines (borders + dividers)

Token	Value	Use
--hairline	rgba(0,0,0,0.08)	Default borders, divider lines
--hairline-soft	rgba(0,0,0,0.04)	Subtle dividers, card edges
--hairline-faint	rgba(0,0,0,0.02)	Faintest dividers, list rows

Brand accent (interactive blue)

Token	Value	Use
--highlight	#0077C8	121 Group brand blue. Primary CTAs, focus rings, links
--highlight-soft	rgba(0,119,200,0.08)	Soft tint backgrounds (selected state, active chip)
--hover-blue	#0077C8	Same as --highlight. Used in interactive contexts
--hover-blue-dark	#005FA3	Pressed state, hover-on-blue surfaces

--hover-tint	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.08)	Light hover backgrounds
--hover-tint-strong	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.14)	Stronger hover backgrounds
--link-blue	#0066CC	Readable link color on light bg
--btn-bg	#ffffff	Default secondary button background
--btn-bg-hover	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.08)	Secondary button hover background

Status colors

Token	Value	Use
--status-fire	#ff3b30	On Fire — solid color (dots, text, icons)
--status-fire-soft	rgba(255, 59, 48, 0.1)	On Fire — soft tint (pill backgrounds)
--status-risk	#ff9f0a	At Risk — solid
--status-risk-soft	rgba(255, 159, 10, 0.12)	At Risk — soft tint
--status-track	#30d158	On Track — solid
--status-track-soft	rgba(48, 209, 88, 0.12)	On Track — soft tint
--status-onboard	#007AFF	Onboarding — solid (blue dot)
--status-onboard-soft	rgba(0, 122, 255, 0.1)	Onboarding — soft tint
--status-paused	#8e8e93	Paused — solid (gray)
--status-paused-soft	rgba(142, 142, 147, 0.12)	Paused — soft tint
--status-soft	#64d2ff	"Under capacity / informational" cyan (Analytics workload bars, calm signals)
--status-soft-soft	rgba(100, 210, 255, 0.14)	Soft cyan tint
--accent	#ff3b30	Generic destructive accent (delete, danger)
--accent-soft	rgba(255, 59, 48, 0.08)	Destructive soft tint

Avatars + chrome

Token	Value	Use
--avatar-bg	#1d1d1f	Default avatar background (when no color set)
--avatar-fg	#ffffff	Avatar text color
--kbd-bg	#ffffff	Keyboard shortcut pill background
--kbd-border	#d2d2d7	Keyboard shortcut pill border
--nav-bg	rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.72)	TopNav background (semi-transparent for blur effect)
--tag-bg	rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.04)	Generic tag chip background
--tag-text	#636366	Generic tag chip text

Shadows

Token	Value	Use
--shadow	0 1px 3px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.04)	Default card shadow
--shadow-hover	0 4px 16px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.08)	Lifted state shadow
--modal-shadow	0 24px 80px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.18)	Modal elevation shadow

Dark theme tokens

Set these on `[data-theme="dark"]` (or whatever selector your portal uses to flip themes — replace as needed):

Backgrounds + surfaces

Token	Value	Use
--bg	#000000	Page background (pure black, matches iOS dark)
--bg-elev	#1c1c1e	Elevated surfaces (modals, cards, panels)
--bg-soft	#2c2c2e	Recessed surfaces (input fields, hover backgrounds)
--bg-faint	#161618	Subtle alternation

--column-bg	rgba(255,255,255,0.03)	Kanban column wells
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The relationship in dark mode: #000000 < #1c1c1e < #2c2c2e on the lightness axis. The page is pure black. Modals and cards lift to #1c1c1e. Inputs and hover backgrounds sit at #2c2c2e — one notch lighter than the modal.

This follows Apple's iOS dark-mode convention: each surface lifts a small amount as you go up the elevation ladder. Backgrounds get *slightly lighter* as you stack containers; the offset is always subtle (16 levels of gray, not 64). That subtle offset is what makes the input field read as "inside the modal" rather than "on top of the modal."

What portal is doing wrong: the offset is too large. Portal's input fields render too light against the modal, breaking the subtle elevation pattern. The fix is to match our build's exact hex values below. The token relationship in the sheet is already correct — portal's values are off.

Text

Token	Value	Use
--text	#f5f5f7	Primary text
--text-muted	#aeaeb2	Secondary text
--text-soft	#a8a8ad	Tertiary text (WCAG AA contrast on --bg-soft: 5.04:1)
--text-faint	#8e8e93	Disabled / placeholder (WCAG AA on --bg-elev: 4.61:1)

Note: dark-mode text values are deliberately different from light mode. Naively swapping --text-soft from #86868b to its inverse fails WCAG AA contrast on the darker surfaces. Our build's dark values are tuned for AA compliance on --bg-elev and --bg-soft specifically.

Hairlines

Token	Value	Use
--hairline	rgba(255,255,255,0.1)	Default borders
--hairline-soft	rgba(255,255,255,0.06)	Subtle dividers
--hairline-faint	rgba(255,255,255,0.03)	Faintest dividers

Brand accent (same hex, higher alphas on soft tints)

Token	Value	Use
--highlight	#0077C8	Same brand blue (do not change for dark mode)

--highlight-soft	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.14)	Soft tint (alpha lifted from 0.08 → 0.14 for visibility)
--hover-blue	#0077C8	Same
--hover-blue-dark	#005FA3	Same
--hover-tint	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.16)	Hover backgrounds (lifted alpha)
--hover-tint-strong	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.24)	Strong hover (lifted alpha)
--link-blue	#5AC8FA	Apple Light Blue — readable on near-black
--btn-bg	#1c1c1e	Default secondary button background
--btn-bg-hover	rgba(0, 119, 200, 0.18)	Hover background (lifted alpha)

Status colors (subtle tonal shifts for dark mode)

Token	Value	Use
--status-fire	#ff453a	On Fire — slightly brighter for dark bg
--status-fire-soft	rgba(255, 69, 58, 0.16)	Soft tint (lifted alpha)
--status-risk	#ffb340	At Risk — slightly brighter
--status-risk-soft	rgba(255, 179, 64, 0.16)	Soft tint
--status-track	#32d74b	On Track — slightly brighter
--status-track-soft	rgba(50, 215, 75, 0.16)	Soft tint
--status-onboard	#0A84FF	Onboarding — Apple System Blue (dark variant)
--status-onboard-soft	rgba(10, 132, 255, 0.18)	Soft tint
--status-paused	#98989d	Paused — slightly lighter gray
--status-paused-soft	rgba(152, 152, 157, 0.14)	Soft tint
--status-soft	#7ad8ff	Cyan — slightly brighter
--status-soft-soft	rgba(122, 216, 255, 0.18)	Soft tint
--accent	#ff453a	Destructive accent
--accent-soft	rgba(255, 69, 58, 0.14)	Destructive soft tint

Avatars + chrome

Token	Value	Use
--avatar-bg	#f5f5f7	Avatar background flips light in dark mode
--avatar-fg	#1d1d1f	Avatar text flips dark
--kbd-bg	#2c2c2e	Keyboard shortcut pill
--kbd-border	rgba(255,255,255,0.15)	Keyboard shortcut border
--nav-bg	rgba(0,0,0,0.72)	TopNav (semi-transparent for blur)
--tag-bg	rgba(255,255,255,0.06)	Generic tag chip background
--tag-text	#aeaeb2	Generic tag chip text

Shadows (deeper in dark mode)

Token	Value	Use
--shadow	0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.4)	Card shadow (alpha lifted)
--shadow-hover	0 4px 16px rgba(0,0,0,0.6)	Lifted shadow
--modal-shadow	0 30px 80px rgba(0,0,0,0.72), 0 0 0 1px rgba(255,255,255,0.06), inset 0 1px 0 rgba(255,255,255,0.05)	Modal elevation — composite shadow with a hairline outline and an inset highlight for dimensionality

Disabled state

The dark-mode disabled-state opacity is lifted from 0.4 → 0.6 because 0.4 on near-black backgrounds pulled disabled controls below WCAG AA contrast (~2.2:1, read as invisible). Apply this rule once, globally, to every disabled control:

```
[data-theme="dark"] button:disabled,  
[data-theme="dark"] input:disabled,  
[data-theme="dark"] textarea:disabled,  
[data-theme="dark"] select:disabled,  
[data-theme="dark"] [aria-disabled="true"] {  
  opacity: 0.6;  
}
```

Light mode stays at the default 0.4 (the contrast headroom in light mode is large enough to absorb it).

Copy-exactly instructions

- 1 **Replace portal's current token definitions** with the values above. Match exact hex codes and exact alpha values.
- 2 **Match the token names** if you're starting clean. If portal uses different names (-input-bg vs --bg-soft), map them 1:1 and document the mapping somewhere central.
- 3 **Don't generate a palette** from one or two seed colors. The values above are tuned individually — some for WCAG contrast on specific surface combinations, some for Apple HIG alignment, some for the brand. Programmatic palette generators won't reproduce them.
- 4 **Don't add new tokens** without documenting their role here. The token sheet is the design system contract; ad-hoc additions fragment it.
- 5 **Test both themes in parallel** as you swap. Some bugs only surface in one theme — e.g. a focus ring that pops in light mode but disappears in dark.

Verification checklist

After the token swap lands, eyeball these surfaces in both themes (toggle dark mode via the topnav avatar menu) and confirm visual parity with our build:

Forms + inputs

- ☐ Add Client modal — input fields recessed (darker in light, see Add Client modal screenshot in `client-page-qa-round5.pdf`)
- ☐ Add Service modal — input fields, template dropdown
- ☐ Add Quick Link modal — title + URL fields
- ☐ Add Contact modal — name / position / email / mobile fields
- ☐ Notes search input (Client → Notes tab)
- ☐ Client list search input

Cards + panels

- ☐ Client detail header card (look at the divider treatment between client name and the icon row)
- ☐ ACTIVE SERVICES row backgrounds
- ☐ MY TASKS attention card backgrounds
- ☐ MY BOARDS pinned card backgrounds
- ☐ About tab Client Contacts panel
- ☐ About tab Quick Links panel
- ☐ Onboarding tab service cards

Hover states

- ☐ Client list row hover (subtle blue tint)

- ☐ Filter chip hover
- ☐ Button hover (primary + secondary)
- ☐ Service row hover

Focus rings (keyboard navigate with Tab)

- ☐ Input fields show a clear blue (#0077C8) focus ring against the field background — should pop in both themes
- ☐ Buttons show a focus ring on Tab
- ☐ Filter chips show a focus ring on Tab

Status colors

- ☐ On Fire pill (red)
- ☐ At Risk pill (amber)
- ☐ On Track pill (green)
- ☐ Onboarding dot (blue)
- ☐ Paused dot (gray)
- ☐ Cross-check the soft tint backgrounds — the pill background should be a low-alpha version of the solid color

Topnav (per QA policy, topnav differences are intentional, but the *colors* should still match)

- ☐ Avatar background
- ☐ Notification icon color
- ☐ Search button background

Text contrast

- ☐ Body text (`--text`) is fully readable on `--bg-elev` and `--bg-soft`
- ☐ Muted text (`--text-muted`) is readable on every surface
- ☐ Faint text (`--text-faint`) — placeholder text in input fields, timestamp captions — must pass WCAG AA (4.5:1 for body) on dark backgrounds

Source of truth

Our build's full token sheet lives at: `src/styles/flizow.css` lines 1-233 (base tokens) and 11717-11750 (status colors). When the design language evolves, that file is the canonical source — this doc is regenerated from it.

If portal needs to override a token for a portal-specific reason, document the override in the portal's token file with a comment explaining why it diverges. Silent overrides drift the design system.